

QA INTERVIEW ACCELERATOR

Behavioural Interview Prep Workbook

Prepare confident, structured answers to the "soft" questions that decide offers.

Introduction

Technical skill gets you shortlisted; behavioural answers often decide the offer. This workbook helps you prepare for the questions about teamwork, conflict, pressure and growth.

Instructions

- Draft a STAR answer for each question below.
- Use real examples; keep each to ~2 minutes.
- Practise out loud and refine.

Question Bank with Tips

Question	What they are really assessing
Tell me about a defect you are proud of	Impact, thoroughness, communication
Describe a conflict with a developer	Collaboration, professionalism
A time you worked under pressure	Composure, prioritisation
A mistake you made	Honesty, learning mindset
How do you handle ambiguous requirements?	Initiative, communication
Why testing / why this role?	Motivation, fit

Worked Example (conflict question)

"A developer pushed back on a bug I raised (S). I needed to resolve it without friction (T). I calmly re-walked the steps with evidence and framed it around user impact rather than blame (A). We agreed it was valid and fixed it; we worked well together afterwards (R)."

Blank Reusable Template

- Question:
- S / T / A / R:
- Key point to land:

Best Practices

- Stay positive even about conflicts and mistakes.
- Show what you learned.
- Focus on collaboration and user impact.

Common Mistakes

- Speaking negatively about past colleagues.
- No structure, so answers ramble.
- Claiming you have never made a mistake.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

When asked about conflict or mistakes, the interviewer wants maturity, not a perfect record. Show that you handle hard moments calmly and learn from them.